

Georgia Institute of Technology

Project Title: The Effects of Games without Chance: Combinatorial Game Theory MOOC on Student Learning Outcomes

Investigators:

Principal Investigator: Dr. Amanda Madden

Consent Title: Consent to be a Research Subject: Version 2 10/2-/2015

Research Consent Form: In order to better understand how MOOCs help students learn, researchers would like to invite you to participate in a research experiment. This research experiment is optional and your decision to participate or not will not impact your grade in this course.

Purpose: The purpose of this study is to explore how Massive Open Online Courses are changing online education. The study will not only measure the effectiveness and quality of the Georgia Tech MOOC courses but will also inform further research into Massive Open Online Courses.

Exclusion/Inclusion Criteria: Participants in this study must be 18 years and older.

Procedures: If you decide to participate in this study, you will be asked to fill out a background survey, six end of week surveys, and an end of final week survey. All surveys will be provided as links within the course. The surveys will take 10-15 minutes to complete. You will also be asked to participate in discussion forums. In addition, we would also like to review your quiz grades, homework grades, and examination grades that you complete in the MOOC, as well as review your MOOC usage and discussion forum contributions. As part of this research, we would like to correlate your survey results and grades from quizzes, homeworks, examinations, MOOC usage and discussion forum contributions. The data collected will only be used for research purposes.

Risks or Discomforts: The risks involved are no greater than those involved in daily activities such as completing an internet survey or taking part in an internet discussion forum. You should be aware that the experiment is not being run from a 'secure' https server of the kind typically used to handle credit card transactions, so there is a small possibility that responses could be viewed by unauthorized third parties such as computer hackers. The third party sites' security measures may also not match those of the researchers.

Benefits: You are not likely to benefit in any way from joining this study. We hope that the information that you have provided will help us redesign the course and will also provide insight into new learning strategies.



Compensation to You:

There is no compensation for participation in this study.

Confidentiality:

The following procedures will be followed to keep your personal information confidential in this study: Your confidentiality will be kept to the degree permitted by the technology being used. No guarantees can be made regarding the interception of data sent via the internet by any third parties. To protect your privacy, your records will be kept under a code number rather than by name. Your name and any other fact that might point to you will not appear when results of this study are presented or published. Data may exist on backups or server logs beyond the timeframe of this research project.

You should be aware that the experiment is not being run from a 'secure' https server of the kind typically used to handle credit card transactions, so there is a small possibility that responses could be viewed by unauthorized third parties such as computer hackers. In general, the web page software will log as header lines the IP address of the machine you use to access this page, e.g., 102.403.506.807, but otherwise no other information will be stored unless you explicitly enter it.

To make sure that this research is being carried out in the proper way, the Georgia Institute of Technology IRB may review study records. The Office of Human Research Protections may also look at study records.

Costs to You:

There are no costs to you, other than your time, for being in this study.

In Case of Injury/Harm:

If you are injured as a result of being in this study, please contact Principal Investigator, Dr. Amanda Madden, at telephone (404) 894-6863. Neither the Principal Investigator nor Georgia Institute of Technology has made provision for payment of costs associated with any injury resulting from participation in this study.

Participant Rights:

- Your participation in this study is voluntary. You do not have to be in this study if you don't want to be.
- You have the right to change your mind and leave the study at any time without giving any reason and without penalty.



- Any new information that may make you change your mind about being in this study will be given to you.
- You may print out a copy of this consent form to keep.
- You do not waive any of your legal rights by participating in this research study.

Questions about the Study: If you have any questions about the study, you may contact Dr. Amanda Madden at telephone, (404) 894-6863, or amadden@cc.gatech.edu

Questions about Your Rights as a Research Participant:

If you have any questions about your rights as a research participant, you may contact

Ms. Melanie Clark, Georgia Institute of Technology Office of Research Integrity Assurance, at (404) 894-6942.

[or]

Ms. Kelly Winn, Georgia Institute of Technology Office of Research Integrity Assurance, at (404) 385- 2175.

By completing the online surveys, you indicate your consent to be in the study.

